HACK876 × AD ASTRA PER ASPERA

INFORMATION BOOKLET FOR THE PRINCIPAL

An invitation for Immaculate Conception High School

Build something that should exist.

Date	Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)
Hours	8:00 AM to 7:30 PM
Venue	Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston, Jamaica
Cost	Free for schools and students

Hack 876 is a one-day build competition for Jamaican secondary-school students. In teams of 3 to 4, students choose a real problem, build a prototype that addresses it, and present it to a panel of judges.

The Immaculate page

www.hack876.com/schools/immaculate

Prepared for Mrs. Stacey Wilson Reynolds, Principal

Hack 876 is organized independently of Immaculate Conception High School. This booklet sets out what the day involves and what we would ask of the school.

WHY IMMACULATE

Immaculate already builds.

In April 2024 an Immaculate team won the Crea+Her Girls in ICT Day Hackathon with Auto Farmer, an agriculture app with drone monitoring and an AI-powered water system, and took the Digicel Foundation Impact Award too.

Hackathon winners

First place at the 2024 Crea+Her Girls in ICT Day Hackathon, plus the Digicel Foundation Impact Award.

Robotics

Team Blue Flames was first runner-up at the 2023 FIRST Tech Challenge Jamaica championship.

Olympiad medals

Gold in robotics and silver in computer coding at the 2023 Caribbean Science Olympiad.

STEM Exhibition

An annual exhibition. 2026's theme: Honouring Our Past, Engineering Our Future.

> **"To equip each girl with the necessary attitude, knowledge and skills to enable her to adapt herself and remain flexible in a rapidly changing society and world."**
>
> Immaculate Conception High School, Aims and Objectives · immaculatehigh.edu.jm

Hack 876 adds students from other schools, a fixed deadline, industry mentors and judges who ask teams to explain their decisions. It is a chance for the girls who built Auto Farmer, and the ones coming after them, to do it again in a bigger room.

What students practise

- Defining a real problem
- Designing, building and testing a solution
- Teamwork with students from other schools
- Explaining their work to judges

These are among the skills assessed in CSEC Information Technology and in CAPE Computer Science and Digital Media. Hack 876 is independent of CXC and the Ministry, and taking part does not count toward any SBA.

THE DAY

One day, from first idea to working demo.

A hackathon is an event where small teams build something from scratch in a single day, then present it to judges. No programming experience is needed: teams also need students who design, research, write and present. Mentors who work in industry help throughout the day.

Many students will be at their first hackathon, and no coding experience is needed.

DATE TENTATIVE Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative)	VENUE CONFIRMED Spanish Court Hotel, Kingston	HOURS 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. One day, not overnight.
WHO Students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form (Grades 11 to 13 at Immaculate)	SIZE About 80 students from several schools	TEAMS 3 to 4 students per team

The full schedule

One day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM. Not overnight.

ARRIVE

8:00 AM	Doors open
9:00 AM	Opening
9:20 AM	Keynote
9:35 AM	Challenge reveal

BUILD

9:45 AM	Hacking begins
12:00 PM	Lunch
3:00 PM	Submissions open
4:00 PM	Hacking ends

SHOW

4:15 PM	Judging
5:30 PM	Finalists announced
5:45 PM	Finals

CELEBRATE

6:45 PM	Awards
7:00 PM	Photos + hangout
7:30 PM	That's a wrap

WHAT STUDENTS BUILD

Real problems, working prototypes.

Each team picks a track for inspiration, chooses a real problem within it, and builds a working prototype. The tracks guide ideas. They do not limit them.

Life
Make everyday life better.

Learn
Rethink how people learn.

Culture
Build around Jamaican stories, creativity, language, or culture.

Business
Build for entrepreneurs and small businesses.

Move
Rethink transportation, mobility, and getting around.

Wellbeing
Create something that supports healthier lives.

Resilience
Think climate, infrastructure, emergencies, or community resilience.

Wildcard
Build something nobody asked for.

What teams can make
Websites · Apps · AI tools · Games · Hardware · Data projects · Automations · Agents · Interactive experiences

What we ask every team to do

01
Solve something real.
Start with a problem or moment you actually understand.

02
Make something that works.
A rough demo that runs beats a perfect slide deck.

03
Try something bold.
Take a swing. Judges notice ambition.

04
Know what you built.
Explain how it works, why it matters, and what's next.

WHO WILL BE IN THE ROOM

Judges and organizers.



Sheneska Williams
Judge · HashiCorp (Terraform)
Immaculate Conception High School · USF
Immaculate past student



Dominic Saunders
Judge · Tesla
Campion College · Princeton



Jordan Howell
Judge · Microsoft
Campion College · Kettering



Joshua Ardito
Judge · Meta
Campion College · Carnegie Mellon



Tahj Atkinson
Judge · Google
Campion College · Illinois Tech



Kendall Todd
Judge · Accenture
Hillel Academy · UF



Netania Mundell
Judge · Diageo
St. Andrew High School for Girls · UWI · NYU

ORGANIZERS



Nadani Dixon
Organizer · Redfin
Campion College · Middlebury · Georgia Tech



Stefen Ewers
Organizer · Georgia Tech
Campion College · Hillel Academy · Georgia Tech

Organisations are each person's employer, listed for context. They are not event sponsors unless stated.

Confirmed schools: Campion College, Hillel Academy

CONFIRMED SPONSORS

P237 Labs · organizing partner

Lev Beauty

Vault Motors

Norus Technologies

Frankies

HOW WORK IS JUDGED

How the judges decide.

Each team demonstrates its project to the judges. These are the lenses they use, in plain language. There are no point values.

Problem & Insight
Did you find something worth fixing, and do you get why it matters?

Product & Solution
Does your idea actually answer the problem?

Execution
Does it work? How much did you really build today?

Originality
Is it fresh, or a new take on something familiar?

Impact
Who would this help, and how much?

Pitch & Demo
Can you show it and explain it clearly?

Complexity alone does not win Hack 876.

Prizes

Hack 876 Winner	iPad per student (up to 4)
Second Place	AirPods Pro per student (up to 4)
Third Place	US$150 gift card per student (up to 4)
Best Design	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)
Boldest Idea	US$200 team project grant
People's Choice	US$50 gift card per student (up to 4)

Prizes are tentative and subject to change.

Prizes are a bonus; the experience of building is the point.

No. Hack 876 does not offer or promise internships, jobs, scholarships, interviews or placements.

SAFETY, SUPERVISION AND COST

What families and the school can rely on.

Supervision
Students are supervised by Hack 876 staff and volunteers for the whole day, at the Spanish Court Hotel.

One day
It is not overnight. Hack 876 runs for a single day, from 8:00 AM to 7:30 PM, and every student goes home that evening.

Access and medical needs
Tell the organizers as early as possible, at info@hack876.com, so arrangements can be made with the venue.

AI tools
Students use only organizer-approved, age-appropriate tools. Students under 18 will not use adults-only tools at Hack 876, with or without permission.

Consent
Every participant needs a consent form signed by a parent or guardian. This applies whatever the student's age.

Food
Food is provided on the day, and the schedule includes a lunch break. Accepted students will be asked about allergies and dietary needs in advance.

Emergencies
Every family will be given an on-site contact and the emergency procedure before the event.

Conduct
The Code of Conduct and Event Rules are at www.hack876.com/code-of-conduct and www.hack876.com/rules.

Not provided

Transport: No transport has been arranged, so families should plan to bring students to the Spanish Court Hotel for 8:00 AM and collect them at 7:30 PM.

Devices: Every student needs to bring their own laptop or other device to build on, plus a charger. Hack 876 is not providing laptops or other hardware.

Cost

Hack 876 is free. There is no fee for the school or for students.

Being finalised, shared with families before the event

- **Supervision:** The number of supervising adults and the written safeguarding procedures.
- **On-site contact:** The on-site contact details.
- **AI tools:** Which tools are approved, and the age limit for each.
- **Consent form:** The exact wording of the form and how it is returned.
- **Arrival and collection:** Drop-off and pick-up procedures, and whether any transport will be arranged.
- **Food:** The menu.

NEXT STEPS

What we ask of Immaculate.

- Confirm Immaculate's participation by email to info@hack876.com.
- Name a member of staff as our contact.
- Share the opportunity with eligible students in 5th Form through Upper 6th Form (Grades 11 to 13 at Immaculate), and recommend those who would enjoy it.
- Advise us on school permissions and on communication with parents.

Immaculate is not asked to pay, host, organize, transport or supervise anything.

For planning, we have roughly 8 to 12 Immaculate students in mind: an estimate, not a quota or a promise.

First	An email to info@hack876.com confirming Immaculate's participation and naming a staff contact.
If Immaculate agrees	Support in principle, and a school-side contact.
Then	Teachers share the opportunity, and girls apply.
Before the event	Accepted students and their families receive consent forms.
Event day	Hack 876, Saturday 20 February 2027 (tentative).

Email info@hack876.com to confirm Immaculate's participation

We wrote to you by email on 16 October 2026 and would be glad to hear from you.

Stefen Ewers and Nadani Dixon, co-organizers · info@hack876.com

Prefer to talk first? Book 15 minutes: calendly.com/hack876-info/30min

Immaculate teaches through difficulties to excellence.

Let's give a few Immaculate girls one day to build their way there.

Hack 876

www.hack876.com

The Immaculate page

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